

Environment & Tooling Overview

What each system in the stack is for, at a glance.

Vercel — Hosting for the app and serverless backend functions. Handles deploys (push to GitHub, auto-deploys), environment variables, and lightweight cron scheduling (Hobby plan caps at 12 functions and once-daily cron).

Supabase — The database. Postgres with a REST API on top, so the app can read/write without a separate backend server. Also handles auth tooling and storage if needed. Has a request-level timeout, so very large one-off operations (bulk deletes, full-table rewrites) need a direct Postgres connection instead of the REST API.

GitHub — Source control and CI via GitHub Actions. Used for anything that needs to run on a schedule more often than the hosting platform's cron allows, or for syncing data between systems on a timer.

Pushover — Push notifications to a phone. Good for real-time alerts that need to interrupt you — something fired, something needs attention.

Resend — Transactional email delivery (receipts, alerts, reports) when email is a more appropriate channel than a push notification.

cron-job.org — External, free cron scheduler. Useful as a backup trigger or for schedules that don't fit cleanly into the hosting platform's built-in cron.

pgAdmin — Desktop GUI for connecting directly to the Postgres database, bypassing the REST API layer. Needed when an operation is too slow/large for the API's timeout limits.

Things you may also want, depending on the project

- **Domain/DNS provider** (e.g. Namecheap, Cloudflare) if this needs a custom domain.
- **Error monitoring** (e.g. Sentry) to catch and alert on runtime errors in production.
- **Analytics** (e.g. Plausible, PostHog) if you want usage data on the app itself.
- **Object storage** (e.g. S3, or Supabase Storage) if the app needs to handle file uploads.
- **A staging/preview environment** — Vercel gives you this for free on every PR/branch, worth using before merging to main.
- **Secrets manager** — for anything beyond what fits comfortably in Vercel/GitHub environment variables.